



WHAT IS PARLIAMENTARY PROCEDURE?



Basic Rules

“Only one subject may be before a group at one time. Each item to be considered is proposed as a motion which usually requires a "second" before being put to a vote. Once a motion is made and seconded, the chair places the question before the group by restating the motion.

"Negative" motions are generally not permitted. To dispose of a business item, the motion should be phrased as a positive action to take, and then, if the group desires not to take this action, the motion should be voted down. The exception to this rule is when a group is asked to take action on a request and wishes to create a record as to why the denial is justified.

Only one person may speak at any given time. When a motion is on the floor, Robert's Rules outlines a speaker order, allowing the mover of a motion to speak first, so that the group understands the basic premise of the motion. The mover is also the last to speak, so that the group has an opportunity to consider rebuttals to arguments opposing the motion.

All members have equal rights. Each speaker must be recognized by the chair prior to speaking. Each speaker should make clear their intent by stating, "I wish to speak for/against the motion" prior to stating an argument.

The rights of the minority must be protected, but the will of the majority must prevail. Persons who don't share the point of view of the majority have a right to have their ideas presented for consideration, but ultimately the majority will determine what the group will or will not do. Use parliamentary procedure as a tool, not a bludgeon.”

In Parliamentary Procedure using Robert's Rules of order, Colorado uses the Single Subject and Original Purpose Requirements in writing legislation, it is used to prevent legislators from sneaking "riders" into bills and forces focus on a single, clear topic.

mrsc.org/explore-topics/public-meetings/procedures/parliamentary-procedure
"Article V. Section 21. Bill to contain but one subject - expressed in title. | 1876 — Current | Colorado Constitution | 50 Constitutions"